

The 12-Point Akiya Risk Checklist

Twelve questions that catch most problems hidden in cheap Japanese houses — each with the Japanese line to paste into an email to the agent (不動産会社). Ask all twelve before you pay a deposit.

A. CAN YOU REBUILD?

1 Is the property 再建築不可 (rebuilding prohibited)?

If yes, you can never replace the house — after a fire, a typhoon, or simply old age. Banks will not lend against it and resale is very hard.

JA: この物件は再建築不可ですか？再建築可能な場合、その根拠（接道状況）を教えてください。

2 Does the lot touch a road of 4 m or wider for at least 2 m (接道義務)?

This is the rule behind question 1. Private roads (私道) and unregistered paths often fail it.

JA: 接道している道路の幅員と接道の長さ、公道か私道かを教えてください。

3 Is a setback (セットバック) required, and how many m² would be lost?

If the road is narrower than 4 m you must give up part of the lot when rebuilding.

JA: セットバックは必要ですか？必要な場合、何m²減りますか？

4 Is the lot inside a 市街化調整区域 (urbanization control area)?

Rebuilding, extensions and change of use need special permission there; some buyers cannot get it at all.

JA: 市街化調整区域内ですか？農家以外の者が建て替え・増改築する場合の許可の可否を教えてください。

B. NATURAL HAZARDS

5 What does the official hazard map say about flood depth at this address?

MLIT publishes maximum-scale flood depth for every river basin. Depth of 3 m or more means the first floor is under water.

JA: ハザードマップ上の洪水浸水想定（想定最大規模）の浸水深を教えてください。重要事項説明での水害リスク説明をお願いします。

6 Landslide warning zone (土砂災害警戒区域) or tsunami inundation zone — yes or no?

Both are mandatory disclosure items in Japan; insurers and lenders treat them differently.

JA: 土砂災害警戒区域・特別警戒区域、津波浸水想定区域に該当しますか？

C. UTILITIES & TENURE

7 Public sewer or septic tank (浄化槽)? When was the tank last inspected?

A septic tank costs roughly ¥50,000–80,000 a year in legally required inspections and pumping; an old one may need replacing (¥1,000,000+).

JA: 排水は公共下水ですか、浄化槽ですか？浄化槽の場合、種類・設置年・最終点検日を教えてください。

8 Public water supply, or a well / simple water system?

Wells need testing and pumps; some rural areas have private water associations with joining fees.

JA: 上水道は公営水道ですか？井戸・簡易水道の場合、水質検査結果と維持費を教えてください。

9 City gas or propane (プロパン)? Is there a supply contract to take over?

Propane is common in the countryside and costs more; some contracts tie you to a supplier.

JA: ガスは都市ガスですか、プロパンですか？引き継ぐ供給契約や設備の所有関係はありますか？

10 Freehold (所有権) or leasehold (借地権)?

With leasehold you buy only the building and pay ground rent; the landowner's consent is needed to sell or rebuild.

JA: 土地は所有権ですか、借地権ですか？借地の場合、地代・残存期間・地主の承諾条件を教えてください。

11 Are there any 告知事項 (disclosure matters) — deaths, incidents, disputes, boundary problems?

Agents must disclose these, but only if you ask in writing before the contract.

JA: 告知事項（事故・事件・近隣トラブル・境界問題など）はありますか？境界確定の有無も教えてください。

12 If it's an akiya-bank listing: residency, age or renovation obligations? And the build year — before or after June 1981?

Municipal akiya banks often require you to live there, or to renovate within a set period. Pre-1981 houses were built to the old seismic standard (旧耐震).

JA: 空き家バンク物件の場合、居住義務・年齢制限・改修義務などの条件はありますか？建築確認日は1981年6月以降ですか？

Want these answered from the official datasets for one specific listing — flood depth, zoning, population trend, nearby transactions — with deal-breakers at the top and a bilingual question list? [Get a \\$49 Akiya Check report →](#)